

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

CDC panel creates confusion on shots

Advisers fail to offer clarity on COVID, other vaccinations

By Mike Stobbe and Lauran Neergaard
Associated Press

ATLANTA — Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr.'s new vaccine advisers added confusion Friday to this fall's COVID-19 vaccinations — declining to recommend them for anyone and leaving the choice up to those who want a shot.

Until now, the vaccinations had been routinely provided to nearly all Americans who wanted them. The Food and Drug Administration recently put new restrictions on this year's shots from Pfizer, Moderna and Novavax, reserving them for people over age 65 or younger people who are deemed at higher risk from the virus.

In a series of votes, advisers to the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention didn't specifically recommend vaccination but said people could make individual decisions.

The panel also urged the CDC to adopt stronger language about the supposed risks of vaccination, an idea that drew resistance from outside medical groups who said the shots had a proven safety record.

And the divided panel also narrowly avoided urging states to require a prescription for the shot.

Dr. Sean O'Leary of the American Academy of Pediatrics called the decision not to recommend vaccination "extraordinarily vague" and said it would have "real-time impacts on American children."

He said the discussion involved clear efforts to "sow distrust" about vaccines.

"It was a very, very strange meeting," O'Leary said.

On Friday morning, the committee voted not to allow a federal vaccine program to cover the cost of a combination vaccine known as MMRV that protects against measles, mumps, rubella and varicella, or chickenpox. This reversed a vote Thursday to allow coverage, apparently because some members had misunderstood the way it was worded.

The panel had recommended Thursday that for children under 4, their first dose of protection against MMR — measles, mumps and rubella — and chickenpox should be in separate shots, not the MMRV combination. Since 2009, the CDC has said it prefers separate shots for initial doses of those vaccines and 85% of toddlers already do.

And the panelists said they felt unready to decide whether to

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Curtis Evans, of Evanston, carries a U.S. flag through gas deployed by federal officers as they clear protesters from the entrance of the Immigration and Customs Enforcement facility in Broadview on Friday. Evans said he was a Marine during President Ronald Reagan's term. STACEY WESCOTT/TRIBUNE

At Broadview ICE facility, protesters, agents clash

Tear gas, pepper spray used as crowd of about 100 protesters try to block vans

By Caroline Kubzansky and Rebecca Johnson
Chicago Tribune

Federal agents hurled tear gas and pepper spray into a crowd of about 100 protesters who attempted to block vans from entering and exiting a U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement holding facility in Broadview Friday morning.

Protesters flocked to the west suburban building, which had its

windows and doors boarded up, early in the morning to protest the Donald Trump administration's immigration crackdown known as "Operation Midway Blitz." Protesters chanted, sang and screamed at a group of agents in military fatigues and masks who walked back and forth on the building's roof.

At around 8:30 a.m., agents threw multiple gas canisters and fired pepper-spray balls to disperse the crowd as a group of

people were trying to block a van from leaving the building. Agents grabbed one man who appeared to be charging up the driveway, pinned him to the ground and hustled him behind the gate with his hands behind his back.

Protesters said two other people had been detained that morning. The U.S. Department of Homeland Security later confirmed in a news release that federal law enforcement arrested three protesters.

Homeland Security characterized the protest as an "organized effort to obstruct ICE law enforcement," accusing protesters of throwing tear gas cans and assaulting officers. The department pointed the finger at Democratic politicians who it said have "villainized and demonized ICE law enforcement."

"The violent targeting of law enforcement in Illinois by lawless

Turn to ICE, Page 2

Northwestern students return amid challenges

School faces change in leadership, mounting federal pressures

By Kate Armanini
Chicago Tribune

The sun beat down on Northwestern University's lakefront campus Friday, as students hurried to classes in the first week of the academic year.

Though the Evanston school has grappled with a flurry of challenges in recent months — includ-

ing a \$790 million federal funding freeze and the sudden resignation of President Michael Schill — the mood was light on campus ahead of the weekend.

Most students were unfazed by the mounting federal pressures, and knew little of Schill's interim successor.

"I think outside looking in, I know a lot of people are probably like, 'Oh, Northwestern is going through so much, it's probably ruining the atmosphere,'" said

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Students walk on campus during the first week of undergraduate classes at Northwestern University in Evanston on Friday.

E. JASON WAMBSGANS/CHICAGO TRIBUNE



JOHN J. KIM/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Edgar lies in state ahead of funeral

A mourner views the casket of former Gov. Jim Edgar lying in state at the Illinois Capitol in Springfield on Friday, a day before his funeral.

Toymaker takes tariffs challenge to high court

Vernon Hills sister companies produce half their products in China

By Angela Mathew
Chicago Tribune

In an airy warehouse in Vernon Hills, workers pack educational toys designed to bring children joy and expand their worlds. Plastic apples that can be taken apart to understand fractions, a toy cash register and a kit with a purple stethoscope are stacked on blue metal racks, waiting to be shipped to a budding elementary school CEO or doctor.

The orderly buzz of workers

driving forklifts and the routine whirring of a conveyor belt belie the fact that Learning Resources and its sister company, hand-2-mind, have been in the eye of a storm trying to adapt to tariffs. The companies produce around 50% of their products in China.

When the Trump administration's tariffs on goods from China shot up in April from around 20% to around 104%, CEO Rick Woldenberg, who has a law degree from the University of Chicago, decided he couldn't stand by and watch. He hired counsel and sued President Donald Trump's administration in federal court, saying that the tariffs

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TODAY'S WEATHER



High 80 Low 65

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 8

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
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